

Continuing Improvements to the OSS Supply Chain Ecosystem

The royalty-free Open Invention Network licence establishes an expectation for OSS-related behaviour — specifically, patent non-aggression within core open source technologies. Such initiatives strengthen the OSS supply chain ecosystem, and it's important that more organisations join this network.

At the beginning of the 20th century, for the most part, production was local in nature, as it had been for several millennia. By the latter half of the century, with improvements in shipping and telecommunications, companies turned to lean production models (e.g., the Toyota Production System). Telecommunications meant that it was possible to specify

components to a third party which was not local. Containerisation and transportation improvements meant that components could be transported cheaply and be delivered just-in-time by a supplier that was not local.

This allowed the production process to be modularised and contracted out, improving the efficiency of production. In today's world, in which the Internet has

driven communication costs down, companies no longer believe it is in their best interests to self-produce or locally source all components. Because of this, the world's largest companies have built increasingly global and complicated supply chains. Benefiting from the computing and communications revolution that started in the 1990s and continues today, these companies are increasingly

